Part 1:

The Facts of Photography as an Art Process:

Andrews explains that photography uses a camera, lenses, light, chemicals, and printing techniques to reproduce nature. He believes photography can capture details of objects, landscapes, clouds, flowers, and waves with incredible accuracy. However, he identifies three weaknesses: excessive detail, lack of atmosphere, and a lack of artistic education and feeling. He argues that photography is a machine-made art, but the person operating the camera makes all the difference. In my opinion, a camera alone cannot make a beautiful photograph. The photographer must understand composition, lighting, and the right moment to capture something meaningful (Andrews, 1892, pp. 2–7).

The Character of the true artist:

According to Andrews, a true artist needs patience, imagination, education, and artistic feeling. He explains that photographers must learn to "watch and wait" instead of taking countless pictures without thinking about their subjects. He even suggests visiting a location at different times and carefully deciding what to include or leave out. He gives the example of painter Corot, who woke up at three in the morning to capture beautiful morning effects. I think this shows that good art requires dedication and patience. Having expensive equipment does not automatically make someone an artist. What matters is the ability to recognize beauty and express it creatively (Andrews, 1892, pp. 5–8).

Photography in Service of the Arts:

Andrews believes photography should support traditional art rather than replace painting. Photographs help painters study details, lighting, landscapes, animals, and objects that may be difficult to observe for long periods. He also explains that photography is useful for reproducing paintings, drawings, sculptures, and historical objects. However, he warns that photographs should not become a substitute for an artist's own effort. He mentions that photography can actually encourage talented painters to improve their work by helping them understand nature more closely. I agree because photography and painting have different strengths, and using technology as a creative tool does not mean we should lose traditional artistic skills (Andrews, 1892, pp. 12–18).

Part 2:

Quote 1:

Ans 1: According to Andrews, artistic feeling means having the ability to recognize beauty, understand composition, and express something creatively. It is not just about knowing how to operate a camera or use technical equipment. He explains that artistic feeling should be developed through education, studying nature, and observing the work of famous artists such as Turner, Constable, and Corot. I think it also means having your own way of seeing things instead of simply copying what everyone else sees.

Ans 2: Artistic feeling makes a mechanical process meaningful because the person behind the equipment makes creative decisions. Andrews explains that photographers should carefully select their subjects, understand lighting, and learn to wait for the right moment. For example,

taking a photograph during a beautiful sunset requires more than simply pressing a button. This idea also connects to Jason Allen's AI artwork because he experimented with prompts and selected his preferred results. In both situations, the technology is only a tool, while human decisions influence the final work.

Quote 2:

Ans 1: Emerson's metaphor means that nature becomes art when it passes through the human mind and imagination. Andrews uses this idea to explain why painting is more than simply copying what exists in the real world. An artist selects certain details, changes the presentation, and adds personal expression through light, shade, and color. Andrews believes that painting reflects the individual genius of the artist. I think this is what makes artwork special because it allows people to express their own feelings and experiences through something they observe in nature.

Ans 2: The transformation happens when an artist uses imagination, emotions, personal experiences, and creative decisions to change how nature is presented. For example, two artists can paint the same landscape, but one might focus on its peaceful atmosphere while another highlights its dramatic colours and shadows. Andrews explains that painters select and idealize forms instead of reproducing every detail exactly. This idea can also apply to AI art because Jason Allen used his creative prompts and selected generated images to achieve a particular visual result. However, the amount of human transformation is important when deciding how much artistic authorship belongs to him.

Quote 3:

Ans 1: Hamerton believes photography mainly records what already exists in front of the camera instead of creating something through human imagination. He thinks that capturing accurate details of people and places is useful, but accuracy alone does not make something fine art. Andrews partly understands this argument because he also explains that photography can suffer from excessive detail and a lack of atmosphere. However, Andrews disagrees with Hamerton's extreme conclusion. He believes that a photographer with artistic feeling can produce beautiful and meaningful work. Personally, I think Hamerton overlooks how much creativity goes into choosing the subject, lighting, focus, and composition.

Ans 2: Under Hamerton's argument, a medium must go beyond simply recording reality and demonstrate imagination, originality, and personal artistic expression to qualify as fine art. It should involve more than technical accuracy because a perfect reproduction does not necessarily communicate an artist's feelings or ideas. This is also an important question in the AI controversy. Jason Allen's artwork was visually detailed, but the debate was whether his creative decisions or the AI system should receive more credit. I believe artistic expression and meaningful human involvement are important when judging whether a work should be considered fine art.

Ans 3: Hamerton would argue that photography mainly records nature mechanically and does not transform it through human consciousness in the same way painting does. Emerson's alembic suggests that art requires nature to be processed through human imagination and creativity. Andrews presents a more balanced position. He explains that photography can become more artistic when guided by someone with proper artistic feeling and knowledge. The AI controversy raises a similar question because Midjourney generates images using algorithms,

but humans still provide prompts and select results. In my opinion, technology does not completely bypass human creativity, but the level of human involvement makes a major difference.

The Kinship of Media:

I believe digital art and traditional painting are like sisters because both allow people to express creativity using different tools. Generative AI can also belong to this family, but the amount of human involvement matters. In the assigned video, Jason Allen's artwork, Théâtre D'opéra Spatial, created using Midjourney, became controversial after winning first place in the 2022 Colorado State Fair digital art competition. Allen reportedly spent around 80 hours generating and reviewing approximately 900 images before reaching his final result. This connects with Andrews's argument that technology can produce better artistic results when guided by someone with artistic feeling. However, Hamerton might argue that the machine is doing too much of the creative work. I think AI can be a creative tool, but human imagination should still guide the process.

Evaluating the Colorado State Fair Verdict:

In my opinion, Allen deserved recognition, but I also understand why traditional artists were upset. He used AI to produce an image in a competition where other artists may have created their work using traditional digital techniques. The controversy became even bigger because the judges reportedly did not initially know that Midjourney had been used. However, after learning about the technology behind the artwork, they maintained their decision. I think the organizers should have clearly established rules about AI before the competition started. Allen

should not automatically be disqualified for using a new tool, but artists should compete under transparent and equal conditions.

My Reasoned Assessment:

I believe AI-generated images can be art, but not every AI-generated image represents meaningful artistic work. Creating detailed prompts, experimenting with different results, selecting images, and making creative decisions require some artistic involvement. However, simply entering a few words and accepting whatever the machine produces is different from developing an artwork through personal skill and imagination. Andrews's argument makes me think that the tool itself is not the most important thing; the person guiding it matters. I see AI as a new creative instrument, but I also believe artists should receive credit for their actual contributions and be honest about how their work was created.